

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1986-11-06

To an individual bahá'í

1 dear bahá'í friend,
2 received, and we are asked to convey its answer to your questions concern-
3 ing bahá'ís celebrating christmas.
4 questions concerning the observance of christmas by bahá'ís were asked
5 of the beloved guardian, and two extracts from letters written on his behalf
6 will be of assistance to your understanding of the bahá'í position.

**The bahá'ís should give up the celebrating of christian holy days
such as christmas. The same applies to bahá'ís of jewish and moslem
extraction etc. however, this is not a thing for the Spiritual Assem-
blies to enforce now; but each one should conscientiously begin to do
this—otherwise, people will never know we are members of a new
7 religion, but will think we are just people believing two or three things at the same
time.**

(15 August 1957)

As regards the celebration of the christian holidays by the believ-
8 ers; it is surely preferable and even highly advisable that the friends
9 should in their relation to each other discontinue observing such holi-
10 days as christmas and New year, and to have their festal gatherings of
11 this nature instead during the intercalary days and Naw-rúz.

(19 march 198)

12 it is important to note, in the second extract, the phrase “in their rela-
13 tion to each other”; it is clear, therefore, that among the members of the
14 bahá'í community the celebrations of former religious dispensations should
15 be abandoned. however, bahá'ís are encouraged to “consort with the fol-

lowers of all religions in a spirit of friendliness and fellowship,” and there is
no harm in bahá’ís sharing christmas with christian relatives or friends.10-1
10-1. Tb, p. 21.10.1

2
2a
2b
3

1986–1992 • The Six Year Plan

19indeed, families may contain both bahá’ís and non-b ahá’ís, and the par-
ticipation by bahá’ís at celebrations of christmas or of other religious ob-
servances, should not be made into a source of conflict but rather be used
as an opportunity for demonstrating the honor due to other religions and also as an
incentive for developing the celebration of bahá’í holy days and
anniversaries.

The house of justice understands the problems of individuals and fami-
lies who have come into the community and who require loving support through
their transition to a new way of life, new holy days, and ways of
celebrating the events of the new dispensation. prayers will be offered for
your own guidance in this situation, which must not become a source of difficulty in
the community.

with loving bahá’í greetings,

Department of the secretariat

11

Passing of the Hand of the Cause of God

Zikrullah Khadem

14, 15 and 16 November 1986

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

wiTh Sorrowful heAr TS ANNouNce p ASSiNg iNdef ATigAble feArleSS de-
feNder f AiTh deeply loved hANd cA uSe zikrull Ah khAdem. hiS STerliNg
ServiceS To The cA uSe, hiS ToTAl coNSecrATioN To TAsKS ASSigNed To him
by beloved gu ArdiAN, hiS ouTSTANDiNg effor TS AS member NATioNAl Spiri-

27 TuAl ASSEmblY crAdle f AiTh, hiS v Alu Able Soul-uplifTiNg STimul ATioN im-
28 pArTed body believerS Nor Th AmericA, p ArTicul Arly uNiTed STATeS bAhá'í
commuNiT y, hiS uNTiriNg eNdeA vorS Through hiS TAlkS AND wriTiNgS iN
SAfegu ArdiNg coveNANT AND iN iNSTilliNg AppreciATioN love for Shoghi
effeNdi Shed uNdyiNg luSTer over period hiS AdmirAble STew ArdShip
29 cAuSe god. offeriNg prA yerS holy ShriNeS progreSS hiS rAdiANT Soul Abhá
kiNgdom. urge hold befiTTiNg memoriAl gATheriNgS hiS NAME AT All
30 houSeS of worShip AS well AS iN All locAl bAhá'í commuNiTieS.

Universal HoUse of JUstice10.4

11 1
12 m eS Sa g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e
13 2012

Infallibility of the Manifestations of God

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]